



366,719*

MOVEMENTS AT POINTS OF ENTRY



119,200

INDIVIDUALS AT ARRIVAL LOCATIONS

OVERVIEW

Following the ceasefire announced on 17 April 2026 in Lebanon, the rate of displacement from Lebanon into the Syrian Arab Republic (hereafter referred to as Syria) has declined compared to the initial phase of the conflict. As a result, approximately 33,887 individuals have returned to Lebanon since the peak of displacement (153,087 arrivals recorded on 27 April 2026).

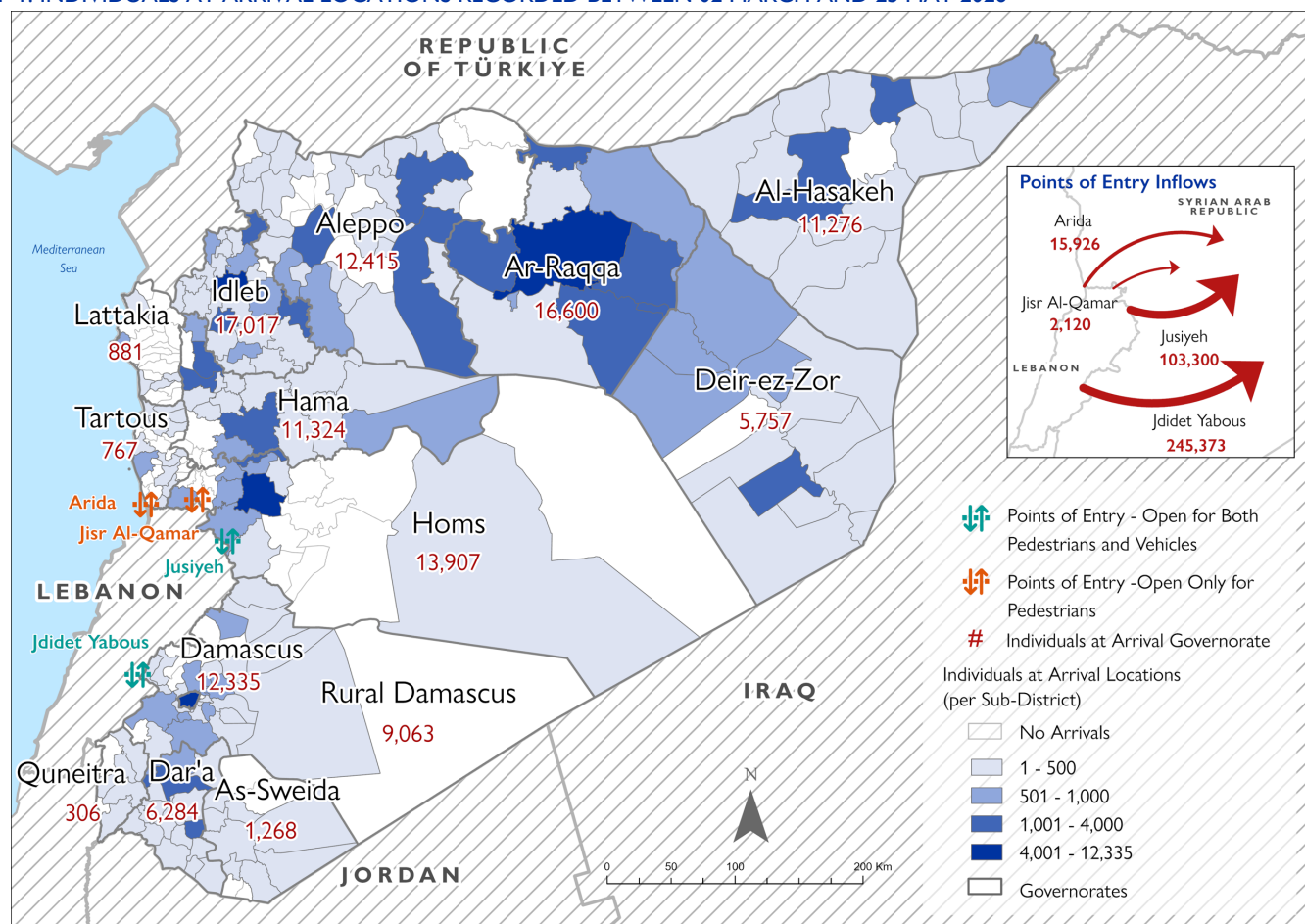
Between 2 March and 25 May, DTM recorded 119,200 individuals arriving across 1,238 locations spanning all 14 governorates in Syria. Arrivals were predominantly Syrian, with Lebanese nationals accounting for less than 1 per cent of those recorded.

As of 25 May, a total of 366,719 movements had been recorded along the four points of entry (PoEs) at the Syrian–Lebanese border where DTM tracks population movements into Syria. The majority of movements recorded involved Syrian nationals (97%), with 3 per cent Lebanese nationals. An additional 2,211 Lebanese nationals were reported to have transited through Syria to Jordan.

During the reporting period, key informants (KIs) reported that new arrivals from Lebanon were visiting for the upcoming Eid holiday, taking the opportunity to assess the situation in Syria. The arrival of new families increased the demand for already limited housing, posing challenges in securing suitable accommodation for returnee families. The arrival of new individuals during this period has exacerbated limited water supplies, health care, and other essential services, compounded by reports of decreasing humanitarian assistance. KIs further reported growing concerns related to persisting security challenges in Syria, increasing anxieties among returnees and their children. In Idleb Governorate, the death of three children and injury of four others as a result of a landmine explosion has fuelled uncertainty among returnee individuals travelling to Syria seeking a relatively stable security situation. Paired with the loss of livelihoods and high living costs in Syria, growing numbers of arrivals from Lebanon are considering return movements.

The situation remains fluid, and DTM continues to monitor developments.

MAP 1: INDIVIDUALS AT ARRIVAL LOCATIONS RECORDED BETWEEN 02 MARCH AND 25 MAY 2026



This map is for illustration purposes only. Names and boundaries on this map do not imply official endorsement or acceptance by IOM

**These figures do not capture regular or routine mobility between Lebanon and the Syrian Arab Republic, including daily commuting, short-term travel, trade and commercial transport flows, or pre-existing circular migration patterns. Data collected through the four official Points of Entry (PoEs), including the Jdeidat Yabous/Masnaa crossing, are therefore selective and event-based, focusing only on movements linked to the crisis context. As such, the figures should be interpreted as indicative of displacement dynamics and humanitarian pressure, rather than as a measure of total cross-border traffic or overall mobility between the two countries.*

TABLE 1: MOVEMENTS AT POINTS OF ENTRY AS OF 25 MAY 2026

PoE	# OF SYRIAN NATIONALS	# OF LEBANESE NATIONALS	TOTAL MOVEMENTS PER PoE
Jdeidat Yabous	243,373	2,000	245,373
Jusiyeh	92,950	10,350	103,300
Arida	15,926		15,926
Jisr Al-Qamar	2120		2,120
TOTAL INDIVIDUALS AT PoEs	354,369	12,350	366,719

TABLE 2: INDIVIDUALS AT ARRIVAL LOCATIONS BETWEEN 02 MARCH AND 25 MAY 2026

GOVERNORATE	# OF SYRIAN NATIONALS	# OF LEBANESE NATIONALS	TOTAL INDIVIDUALS PER GOVERNORATE
Aleppo	11,276		11,276
Al-Hasakeh	12,415		12,415
Ar-Raqqa	16,600		16,600
As-Sweida	1,268		1,268
Damascus	12,335		12,335
Dar'a	6,277	7	6,284
Deir-ez-Zor	5,757		5,757
Hama	11,250	74	11,324
Homs	13,907		13,907
Idleb	16,724	293	17,017
Lattakia	881		881
Quneitra	297	9	306
Rural Damascus	9,048	15	9,063
Tartous	767		767
TOTAL INDIVIDUALS AT ARRIVAL LOCATIONS	118,802	398	119,200

HUMANITARIAN SITUATION AT POINTS OF ENTRY (PoE)

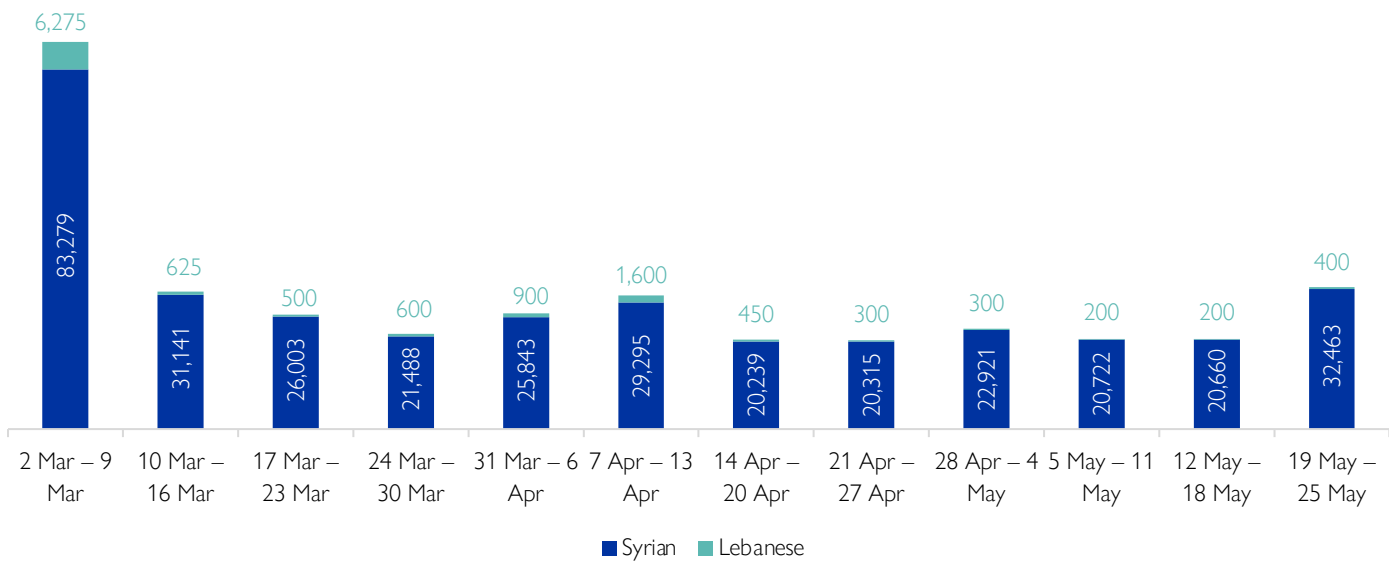
DTM flow monitoring at four Points of Entry (PoEs) along the Syria–Lebanon border continued to record population movements returning into Syria, excluding individuals undertaking routine cross-border travel for commercial or other regular activities.

By 25 May, operational arrangements differed across the monitored crossings. The **Jisr Al-Qamar PoE** in Homs Governorate, which opened on 4 May 2026, remained accessible only to pedestrians. The primary needs identified at this location related to the shortage of affordable onward transportation inside Syria, particularly the limited availability and high cost of cars and buses for onward travel after crossing.

At **Al-Arida PoE**, operating conditions were largely consistent with the previous reporting period. Movement continued to be restricted to pedestrians, while vehicle crossings remained suspended. Reported priority needs included transportation support to Tartous city centre, as well as cash assistance and temporary shelter or rental support for arriving populations.

Meanwhile, both **Jdeidat Yabous (Masnaa)** and **Jousieh PoEs** continued to facilitate crossings for pedestrians and vehicles. Across these locations, the most commonly reported needs included support to cover transportation expenses and access to basic assistance, particularly food and safe drinking water. Additional needs identified included non-food items such as blankets and mattresses, basic medical supplies, and personal hygiene materials.

FIGURE 1: WEEKLY NUMBER OF MOVEMENTS AT POINTS OF ENTRY BETWEEN 02 MARCH AND 25 MAY 2026



PRIORITY NEEDS

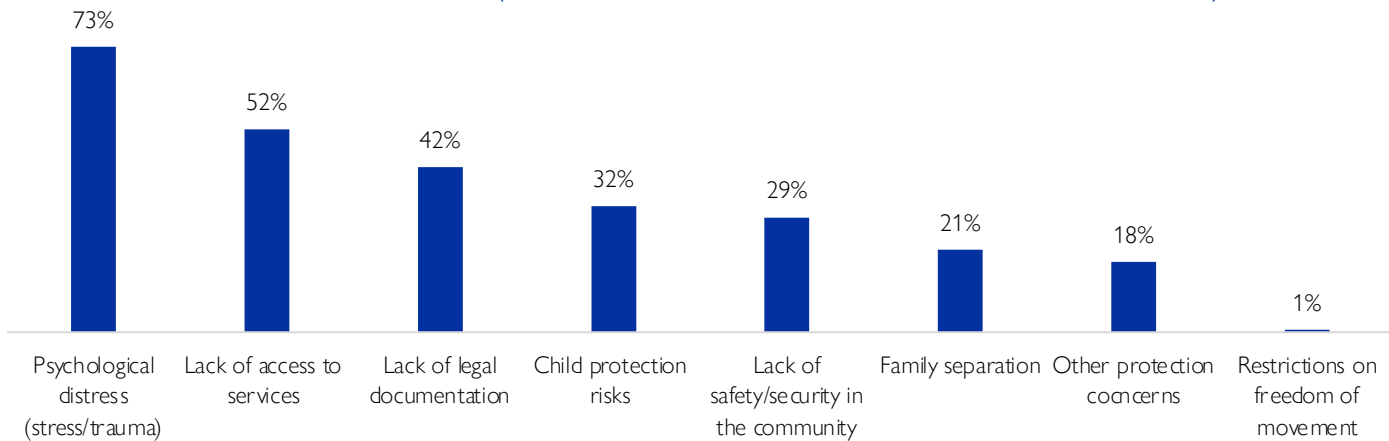
FIGURE 3: TOP NEEDS REPORTED (% OF ARRIVAL LOCATIONS, MORE THAN ONE ANSWER POSSIBLE)



CHALLENGES FACED

According to most KIs (64%), newly arrived populations were generally arriving in stable conditions and without major issues at their points of arrival. Nevertheless, 36 per cent of KIs noted that arrivals continued to face a range of ongoing challenges. Among the reported concerns, psychosocial distress emerged as the most frequently cited issue, identified by 73 per cent of KIs who reported problems. Stress and anxiety were primarily associated with limited livelihood opportunities and the rising cost of living. KIs also highlighted increasing levels of fatigue and emotional strain linked to the protracted conflict in Lebanon and uncertainty regarding future conditions. Challenges in accessing essential services were also commonly reported, cited by 52 per cent of KIs. In addition, 42 per cent referred to issues related to missing or damaged civil documentation, including identity cards, residency permits, and family records, underscoring the need for documentation replacement and administrative support. As in the previous reporting round, the severity of reported risks differed by governorate. The highest proportion of concerns was recorded in Al-Hasakeh (100%), followed by As-Sweida (79%) and Rural Damascus (61%).

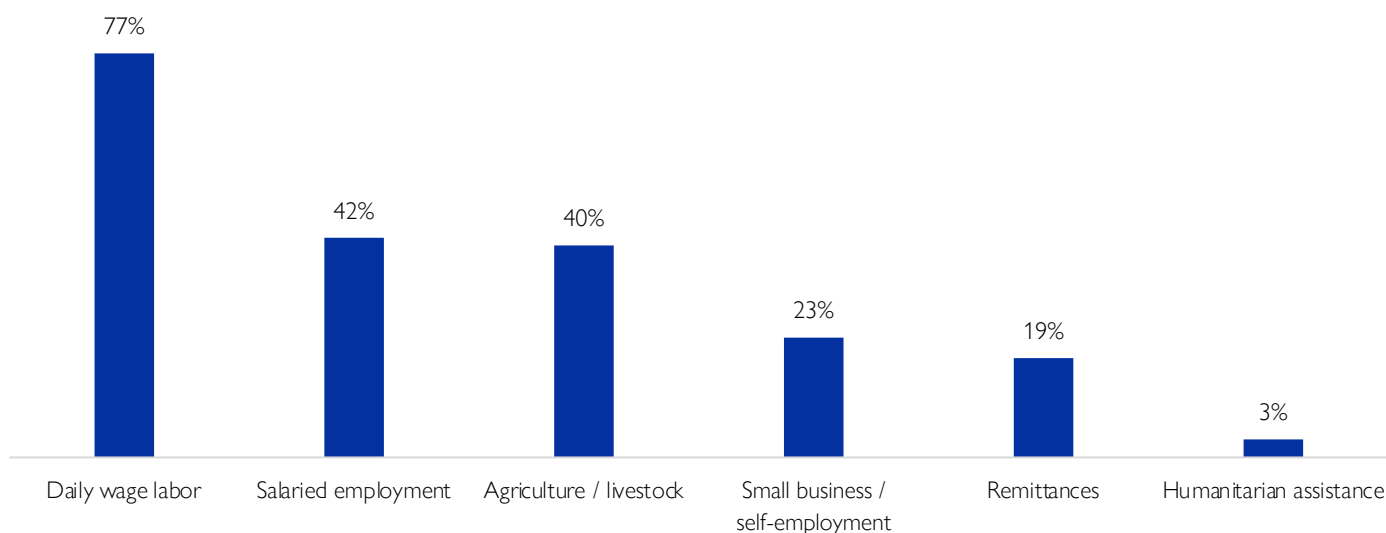
FIGURE 2: PERCEIVED ISSUES AND RISKS FACED (% OF ARRIVAL LOCATIONS, MORE THAN ONE ANSWER POSSIBLE)



LIVELIHOODS AND INCOME

Livelihoods conditions for returnees from Lebanon remained highly constrained, with limited access to sustainable income opportunities and rising living costs continuing to undermine economic stability. In 55 per cent of assessed locations, KIs reported that returnees arrived in Syria without access to employment, reflecting limited livelihood opportunities and intense competition for the few jobs available among both returnees and host communities. Although income-generating activities were reported in 45 per cent of locations, these were consistently described as scarce and insufficient to meet household needs. Daily wage labour was the most commonly cited source of income (77%), followed by salaried work (42%) and agriculture or livestock-related activities (40%). High prices and weak purchasing power continued to strain households, while dependence on unstable daily labour, seasonal agricultural work, remittances, and family support networks raised concerns regarding long-term sustainability. Furthermore, KIs reported growing debt levels and increased financial stress ahead of Eid-related expenses. KIs reported that returnees frequently relied on diminishing savings, remittances, borrowing, or support from relatives to cope with economic pressures, which are often insufficient to cover essential expenses. More than half (53%) reported that income did not meet basic needs at all, while 46 per cent indicated that it only partially covered them. Only 1 per cent of KIs assessed current income levels as sufficient. In several governorates, these pressures contributed to continued onward movement, with some returnees considering or undertaking secondary displacement to Lebanon in order to restore income sources and support their families.

FIGURE 3: PRIMARY SOURCES OF INCOME (% OF ARRIVAL LOCATIONS, MORE THAN ONE ANSWER POSSIBLE)



METHODOLOGY

As of 25 May 2026, IOM's Displacement Tracking Matrix (DTM) teams engaged 5,740 key informants (KIs) across 1,238 locations (admin level 4) in all 14 Governorates across Syria. The objective was to gather indicative estimates of the number of people displaced resulting from the recent escalation in the Middle East region, as well as key information related to the emerging humanitarian situation. In parallel, DTM has established flow monitoring activities at four Points of Entry (PoE) at key border crossing points between Lebanon and Syria to capture cross border flows (inflows into Syria only).

LIMITATIONS

It is important to note that information provided through key informant interviews can be affected by bias, incomplete information, or subjective views which may result in over or under estimation of figures. Furthermore, data collected at FMPs should be understood only as indicative observations. They represent only part of the total flows and is not exhaustive of all crossings and roads that individuals may use. Furthermore, movements recorded at PoEs do not include regular cross-border travellers who frequently move between Syria and Lebanon for trade and other routine activities. Due to variations in population coverage, sources and methodology official sources on movements from Lebanon may differ from official sources on movements to the Syrian Arab Republic.

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